what she had come for, he brusquely told her to leave her application with his personal assistant (PA). And that was it, the end of the interview. She had earlier met the superintendent of the jail regarding the same issue and he had told her that there would be absolutely no problem and that she would have to just take the IG's permission, which was a mere formality. She left her application in the IG's office. When quite some time had elapsed and she did not get any reply to her application, she checked back with the superintendent. She was shocked to hear that the IG had not only refused to give permission but had also declined to put it in writing. She was told that he had this habit of 'killing' an issue by not responding at all.

Kiran, therefore, once again changed the topic of her research work. This time she decided to work on 'Drug Abuse and Domestic Violence'. The number of people already treated, as also those undergoing treatment, at Navjyoti centres, became her data for study. They were very forthcoming in their responses and were very eager to participate in these interviews and fill in the questionnaires that almost became platforms through which they could express their gratitude. Every time she went to Delhi from Mizoram, she would meet batches of twenty or so of these people. That is how her work progressed.

Kiran's posting in Mizoram contributed greatly to her pursuit of studies related to drug and alcohol abuse prevention. Unlike her postings in Delhi, here, she had plenty of time for herself. Mizoram had witnessed a long period of insurgency and had become accustomed to a curfew environment. Then again there was not much street lighting available and life on the streets after 5 p.m. was virtually non-existent and all social activities were over by 6 p.m. Kiran just did not have any official work after 5 p.m. every day, which must have been quite a pleasant surprise to a police officer used to working 16 to 18 hours a day! Such a situation gave enough opportunities to sift through her research material and do a lot of writing. But Kiran gives the entire credit for her PhD work to the institute where she was a scholar, i.e., the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Delhi (Department of Social Sciences). She says the faculty allowed her the freedom to think and plan her work, which was essential for creativity. The IIT provided the best guides in the form of Dr K. L. Nadir, a management expert, and Dr Anuradha Sharma, an expert in the field of psychology. Both were aware of Kiran's potential and, all along, guided her in pursuing her academic work. Anuradha Sharma proved to be a true friend and guru to her. A computer expert and social scientist, Dr B. S. Nagi, of the Council for Social Development, Delhi, helped her analyse her data by applying the latest statistical tests. Kiran was eventually awarded her doctorate for her thesis on 'Drug Abuse and Domestic Violence' in September 1993.

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Consumption of alcohol is very common among Mizos. Many houses brew liquor from rice, called 'Zu', for domestic consumption and sale. The Mizos are voracious meat eaters, with pigs and dogs treated as delicacies. Basically, the Mizos are not cultivators. The abundance of rice, however, is because of the plentiful subsidies provided by the Central Government. Though the state is officially 'dry', yet Zu is available in plenty. Many of her junior police officers were alcoholics. In the beginning she would get nauseated by the reeking odour in her office but then she had to gradually get used to it. Anyway, it was alright as long as the policemen were sober on duty. But they just could not remain like this for more than a few hours at a stretch, sometimes not even for more than two hours. She was not going to interfere in their cultural habits but it did hurt her to see her forces being incapacitated in this manner. She was also trying to investigate the antecedents of the repeat criminals and discovered that most of them were alcoholics. She did not possess any special powers like she